CDE2501 SUSTAINABLE SYSTEMS FOR LIVEABLE CITIES

SITE GUIDE FOR

BRAS BASAH-BUGIS

AY 2025 – 2026 SEMESTER 2

Introduction to Site Guides

Welcome to Liveable Cities! Each of your teams will be working on a site from the following choices – Jurong, Woodlands, Punggol, Bras Basah-Bugis, Chinatown, Tampines and Queenstown.

To help you better navigate your site, we have created site guides to serve as starter packs to help you dive into your projects as quickly as possible.

We provide the following information for each site guide:

1. Maps marking the suggested boundaries of the sites
2. Prompts that spotlight key issues which you can apply to develop your project
3. A list of references to assist with your research

While we welcome you to use the prompts, you do not need to strictly adhere to them. Feel free to combine ideas from the prompts and/or explore other urban issues you are passionate about.

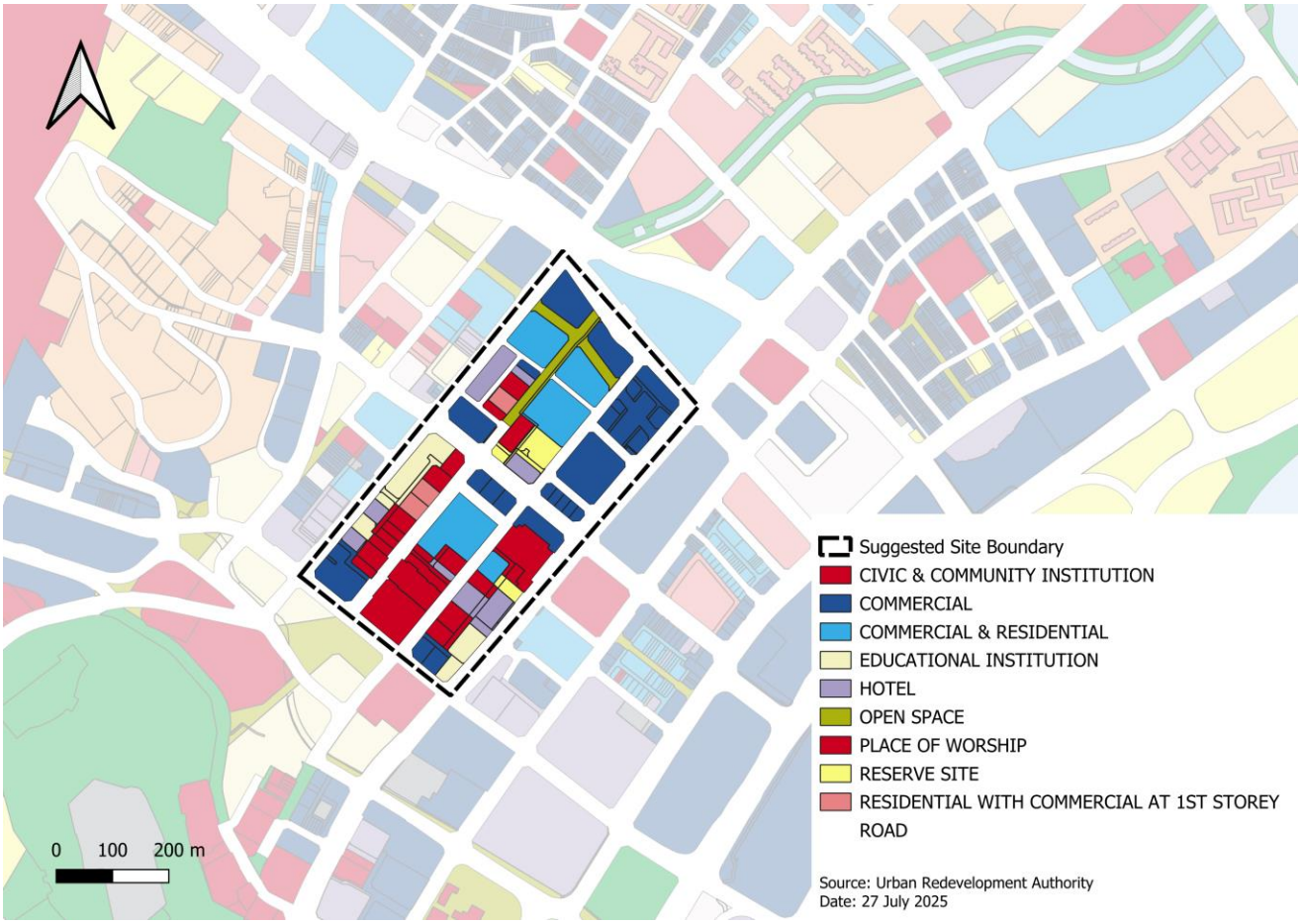
Note: As you learn more about the site and discover what interests the team most, you can also choose to focus on a section of the site and/or extend the site boundaries a little to areas relevant to the issue you are studying.

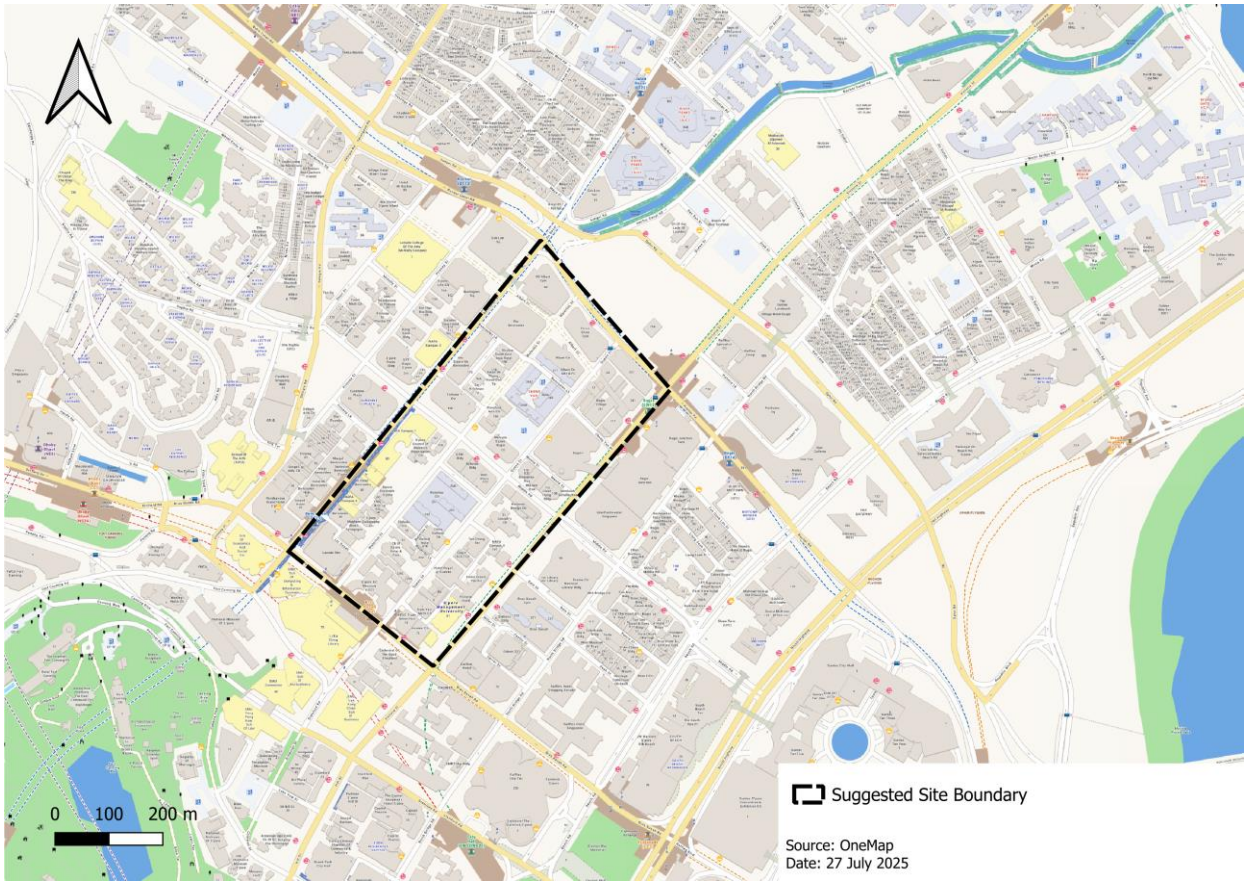
Bras Basah-Bugis

This site contains the following landmarks:

- Institutions of Higher Learning e.g. Singapore Management University (SMU), University of the Arts Singapore (UAS)
- Arts institutions e.g. University of the Arts Singapore (UAS), Objectifs, National Design Centre
- Religious sites e.g. Church of Saints Peter and Paul, St. Joseph's Church (Victoria Street), Sri Krishnan Temple, Kwan Im Thong Hood Cho Temple, Maghain Aboth Synagogue
- Commercial e.g. Waterloo Centre, Fortune Centre, Bugis Street, Bugis+, The Bencoolen, OG Albert Department Store, Fu Lu Shou Complex
- Various hotels and apartments
- Residential housing e.g. Cheng Yan Court
- Transport Nodes: Bras Basah MRT, Bencoolen MRT, Bugis MRT

You can also consider exploring other potential areas in this site as well





Prompts

- Bras Basah-Bugis was planned as an arts and culture district. To what extent has this succeeded? Do you see:
    - Deep engagement with arts and culture among the public and visitors in the district?
    - Artists actively involved in programmes and exhibitions in the area?
- Is the Bras Basah-Bugis contains a mix of businesses, shops and restaurants – some are more unique and address niche interests and needs, others well-known brands that are part of big chains. Do the smaller businesses meet the needs of residents and visitors in the area? Is their survival important for the residents and visitors in the area?
- Bras Basah-Bugis has a particularly high concentration of religious buildings and religious businesses. How do religious activities, events and practices shape the way that Bras Basah-Bugis is utilised by residents and visitors? Are there any impacts of people's use of the district in these ways?

- How accessible are the various landmarks in Bras Basah-Bugis from the MRTs which surround the district?

Starter References

As you read the following references, think about:

- What are the intentions that URA and other government agencies have for Bras Basah-Bugis?
- What are the strategies or interventions they are planning to make to achieve these intentions?
- Are these strategies or interventions sufficient to achieve these intentions?
- In the first place, are these intentions good for Bras Basah-Bugis in helping it to achieve High Quality of Life, Sustainable Environment and Competitive Economy?

URA Draft Master Plan 2025 for Central Area (of which Bras Basah-Bugis is a part of): Central Area | URA Master Plan

Website on Bras Basah's historical development: Bras Basah Through The Years

URA's urban design guidelines for Bras Basah-Bugis: Guidelines for Bras Basah. Bugis Planning Area

Article from National Library Board's publication biblioAsia on Bras Basah's historical development: Rambling Around Bras Basah

Official Website of Bras Basah.Bugis District: Home

Plans to improve walkability and vibrancy of Waterloo Street expected to be completed by 2027, alongside other changes to Bras Basah.Bugis district: Enhancement works planned at Waterloo Street to improve area's walkability, vibrancy - CNA

Article from April 2025 going through slated changes to Bras Basah-Bugis (some of which may have been completed already): New outdoor performance theatre in Prinsep Street among slew of changes in Bras Basah-Bugis district | The Straits Times

Bras Brasah-Bugis is designated as an arts and culture district in Singapore's urban planning. The following two detail Singapore's arts policy and planning approaches to provide some context:

Centre for Liveable Cities (CLC) Urban Systems Studies (USS): A City of Culture: Planning for the Arts: A City of Culture: Planning for the Arts | Centre for Liveable Cities Knowledge Hub (reference to Bras Basah-Bugis in pages 61-62)

National Arts Council (NAC)'s latest Our Singapore Arts Plan: Our SG Arts Plan (2018-2022) | National Arts Council